

INTERNAL MEMO

THE WRONG BELIEF • NO. 02 • 90-SECOND READ

# AI made them faster at finding facts, and less right

128 staff at one industrial firm did three real tasks with and without AI. One result should change how you check its work.

SWIPE →

AI-ASSISTED ANSWERS THAT MISREPORTED OR MADE UP A NUMBER

**~25%**

The right figures were in the company files the AI tool was reading from. The wrong ones were handed in anyway.

# 01 Finding facts: faster, but less correct

With AI, the fact-finding task took 29% less time. Scores for getting the facts right fell, both for numbers and for written details.

## 02 Summaries: faster and better

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Cutting a product text to four sentences or fewer took 52% less time with AI. Expert judges scored it clearly better on 4 of 6 quality measures.

## 03 Ideas: faster and clearer, not more original

Drafting ideas took 39% less time. The ideas were more complete and better argued. Judges found no clear gain in how new they were.

# Where the speed hid the problem

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## SUMMARISE OR DRAFT

The AI output is raw material. You still shape it, and quality went up.

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## LOOK SOMETHING UP

The AI output is the answer. The researchers think people took it as given, and accuracy fell.



**Organizations  
implementing GenAI may  
hence face the risk of  
faster completion  
masking reductions in  
output quality.**

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BOTTESCH ET AL., ARXIV, 28 JUL 2026

What it does not mean: AI is bad at research. The tool was GPT-4o mini, tested in early 2025, at one company.

## DO THIS TODAY

# Trace one number back to its file

When AI hands you a figure, open the document it came from and find it yourself before you forward it. Drafts need a read. Facts need a check.

# One idea, decoded, every week

Plain English, a named source, and one thing to do with it.

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## Decoding AI

FOLLOW FOR THE NEXT ONE